

you. This is your carbon footprint. And this is just your primary footprint; we've not even mentioned about your indirect contributions to the depletion of earth's natural resources.

Plan of action – to protect and preserve

This might be a scary number as it tells you the consequences of your actions on the environment. Well, what's done is done, but awareness without the determination to improve is useless. We all know that planting trees is one of the ways by which to save nature from the ravages of our uninstructed actions, but what if you live in Mumbai and don't have the luxury of huge open spaces? You can still offset your carbon footprint. One method is to donate money to NGOs to plant saplings on your behalf in protected areas. All major airlines have a tie-up with one or another of these NGOs, and give you an option to pay for the sapling plantation during the process of ticket booking. Although it may seem like this will take plenty of dedication and control, this method is inspired by the popular saying "Prevention is better than cure" and it's just small steps that you need to take to save our future.

You must have heard and read some of these on billboards and in newspapers but seeing how we all suffer from selective memory, we'll do a recap. Listed below are major ways by which you can offset your carbon footprint. Not consciously doing so can have the extreme opposite consequence and reasons why there's so much power wastage, not only in India, but across the globe.

- ▶ Turn OFF your lights, TV, DVD player, computer, fans and basically every appliance when not in use and NO, putting it on standby doesn't help
- ▶ Make sure that your Air Conditioner's temperature is around 25 degrees; it's a comfortable temperature and saves a lot of power

